

hands on

Rub your hands together as hard and fast as you can for 10 seconds and see how hot they get. The heat is caused by the force of friction acting on your skin.

To reduce friction, the bottom surface of these skis is very smooth and coated with slippery wax.

Friction

When objects rub or slide against each other, they create a force called friction. Friction slows down moving objects and wastes their energy, turning the energy into heat.

Friction slows down a skier.

Electric forces

When objects become charged with electricity, they pull on each other with an invisible force that is a bit like magnetism. If you rub a balloon on your hair, the balloon becomes charged and will stick to your shirt.

Buoyancy

What makes objects float? The answer is a force called buoyancy. If an object is lighter than water, the force of buoyancy outweighs gravity and the object floats.

Gravity pulls the duck down.

Upthrust from the water keeps the duck afloat.